

- Bio-inspired systems



Keep useful differences alive.

Build a map of alternatives before choosing a winner.

Worked exercise	Stated challenge
Explore with prompts	Own question
Guided	Self-directed

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Choose the decision.

Design a learning activity.

Horizontal axis: guided → self-directed.

Vertical axis: fixed destination → open destination.

These are design choices, not measured scores.

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Place distinct activities.

Guided + fixed: follow a worked exercise.

Self-directed + fixed: solve a stated challenge.

Guided + open: explore with prompts.

Self-directed + open: pursue your own question.

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Improve each kind on its own terms.

What would make the guided exercise genuinely useful?

What would make open exploration worth pursuing?

Do not let one fashionable format erase the others.

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Look at the empty region.

Missing candidate? Poorly chosen axes? An impossible combination?

The gap is a research question, not proof of an opportunity.

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Take this map to a real decision.

Which kind fits the learner's current purpose?
Keep alternatives that would fit a different purpose.

A map does not decide what the person should value.

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**Research anchor: MAP-Elites
preserves strong candidates
across regions of a chosen
feature space.**

This manual product exercise is an analogy,
not the algorithm or a validated learning
intervention.

Source: Mouret and Clune, 2015.